With the Chinese having dug themselves in at Green and Yellow Pimple, Rawlley knew the equation had changed. The enemy was now dominating the Walong area and already their artillery fire had become more accurate. Green Pimple in particular dominated not only Lachhman Ridge but also Maha Plateau. Should the Chinese set up observation posts further south along the spur, they would then have complete domination of both the airstrip and the DZ as well.

On the west bank of the river, 4 Sikh was holding most of the defences and 3/3 GR was still arriving at Walong in small groups. In the mountains, especially at heights close to 12,000 feet, the rule of thumb asserts that the attacker must have a 5:1 ratio for any offensive to succeed. Looking at the maps, Rawlley realized that the Chinese, though they had managed to get to Green and Yellow Pimple, were not likely to be in strength. But with each passing day, they would be able to get more and more troops into the area. The east bank at this stage was relatively quiet. 6 Kumaon, after its advance and then withdrawal from Kibithu, had been kept out of the fighting in order to let the men recover from the exhausting ordeal. He decided, against all conventional wisdom, to pull Alpha Company out of the east bank and launch an attack in the hope of dislodging the Chinese from Green Pimple.

Rawlley briefed Captain R. K. Mathur as each man hauled across the Lohit on the primitive contraption known as the Flying Fox. His primary objective would be to move to the West Ridge and then climb up to the Green Pimple. After dislodging the enemy from there, he was to reconnoitre the route between Green Pimple and Ashi Hill, and, if possible, try and destroy part of the track.